A FREE GUIDE BY SERGIO VEGA · FOR BUSINESSES

5 silent ways Spanish electricity companies overcharge businesses.

For bars, restaurants, shops, holiday lets and small hotels in Spain. A 10-minute guide based on real business bills.

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INTRODUCTION

Why I made this guide.

I spent most of my working life in industry, on production lines, looking for where things were being wasted. Today I do the same with electricity bills, for business owners in Spain who are tired of not understanding theirs.

The first thing almost every owner shows me is the price per kWh. "Is it a good price?" It is a fair question, but it is rarely where the money goes. On a business bill, the money leaks through five lines that sit in the middle of the page, in Spanish, in small print.

They are the same five lines on a bar's bill, a shop's, a holiday let's or a small hotel's. What changes is which of them hurts most. A restaurant full of fridges is not a villa that stands empty half the year, and a shop open from ten to eight is not a beach bar that closes in November.

In this guide you will see real bills from this year: a small hotel, a small factory, a footwear factory in Elche and a food company in Murcia. Names removed, numbers untouched. One of them is a case where the saving on paper was much bigger than the real one, and I put it in on purpose.

The guide is free. There is nothing to buy here. It tells you where to look, what the warning signs are and what each line can cost. If, after reading it, you want me to look at your bill, you can send it to me. If your bill is fine, I will tell you that too, in writing.

Sergio Vega
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THE FIVE LINES

Five lines. Which ones matter in your business.

01

The access tariff

2.0TD, 3.0TD or 6.1TD. Set by how you are connected, and easy to get wrong.

02

Contracted power and the maxímetro

Paid every day, open or closed, busy or empty.

03

Reactive energy

A charge for energy your equipment uses and gives back. It buys you nothing.

04

Meter rental

A daily rent that almost every "saving study" gets wrong.

05

Fixed or indexed, and your contract dates

The one most owners don't know about their own contract, until the bill doubles.

Where to start, by type of business

YOUR BUSINESS	LOOK FIRST AT	WHY
Bar, café or restaurant	**03 · 02 · 05**	Fridges, freezers, extractors and air conditioning. A big peak at service time. Long hours, often into the evening.
Shop or office	**02 · 05**	Steady daytime use. Power and price often set years ago by whoever opened the contract.
Holiday let or villa	**02 · 01 · 05**	Empty weeks that still pay power. Pool, air conditioning and an electric oven can change which tariff a house needs.
Small hotel or guest house	**All five**	Seasons, many machines, sometimes a transformer on the property.
Food production or cold storage	**05 · 03 · 02**	Compressors running around the clock. So much consumption that every euro of supplier margin per MWh becomes thousands of euros a year.
Factory or workshop, such as footwear	**03 · 01 · 02**	Presses, compressors, motors and glue lines, often in shifts. Larger connections where the access tariff matters.
Farm or irrigation	**02 · 03 · 01**	Pumps that run a few months a year, and power paid for all twelve.

LINE 01

The access tariff.

The regulated part of your bill for using the grid. It depends on how your business is connected, not on your supplier.

WHERE TO LOOK Near your contract details: "Peaje de acceso" or "Tarifa de acceso", followed by 2.0TD, 3.0TD or 6.1TD.

WARNING SIGN There is a transformer on your property, and nobody has ever told you whether your access tariff matches it.

What it looks like in different businesses

Bar or restaurant	A kitchen with induction, ovens and extractors running at once can need more power than a small tariff allows.
Shop or office	Many are on the right one. The question is usually the power, not the tariff (line 02).
Holiday let or villa	A pool pump, air conditioning and an oven together can change which tariff the house needs, and that changes the whole price structure.
Hotel, factory, cold store or farm	If the transformer belongs to you, check whether you are on the access tariff that matches it. A food company in Murcia I looked at this year is on 6.1TD.

A REAL BILL

The small hotel has its own transformer and is billed as 3.0TD. Whether that is right is the first thing I am checking, because the wrong access tariff can cost **several hundred euros a year**, whoever the supplier is.

What I check: whether yours is the right one depends on your connection voltage, and that is not printed on the bill. Changing it is not a supplier switch: it involves an electrician and the distribution company. So I also check whether the change pays for itself.

LINE 02

Contracted power and the maxímetro.

The kW you pay for every day of the year, open or closed, busy or empty.
P1 and P2 on 2.0TD, P1 to P6 on 3.0TD and 6.1TD.

WHERE TO LOOK "Potencia contratada", in kW per period. Next to it, "Potencia máxima demandada" or "Maxímetro": the highest power your meter recorded.

WARNING SIGNS The maxímetro is far below your contracted power most months. Or above it, and a line called "Excesos de potencia" appears. Or it shows 0 or "-": your meter is not being read, your bills are estimated ("lectura estimada"), and a correction can arrive months later. Or your power price per kW is higher than the regulated price ("ATR Potencia" or "peajes y cargos") shown on the same bill.

What it looks like in different businesses

Bar or restaurant	The peak is service time, when everything runs together. The maxímetro shows whether your power fits that moment, too short or too generous.
Shop or office	Steady use, so the power is often set once and never looked at again.
Holiday let or villa	Every empty day pays the full power. So does every winter month.
Seasonal business	Hotels and beach bars pay their power in the closed months too.
Farm or irrigation	Pumps that run in the irrigation season, and power paid every day of the year.

A REAL BILL

A footwear factory in Elche pays for **33 kW** in all six periods. In August, almost stopped, power was **more than half** of its bill. And its supplier charges more for that power than the regulated price printed on the back of the same bill: about **34 euros a month**, around **400 euros a year** before tax.

On the next page, a small factory that pays for more than twice the power it has ever used.

What I check: the right power for each period depends on your peaks, your season and the tariff you would move to. Getting it wrong costs money in both directions.

REAL CASE · LINES 02 AND 05

The factory's bill.

A small factory. The same work and the same machines all year. Eleven months of bills, read line by line.

What eleven months of bills showed	
Contracted power	**173 kW**
Highest maxímetro in eleven months	**70 kW**
Share of the paid power it actually uses	**41%**
What that gap is worth	**~4,000 € a year**
Share of its electricity bill	**~17%**
Bill from June to July, same work	**+47%**
Average price, June → July	**0.124 → 0.191 €/kWh**
Before VAT. Names removed, figures as printed on the bills.	

What it shows

Two of the five lines, on the same bill. The power is paid every day for a peak the factory has never reached. And in July, its working hours fall into the most expensive periods of the business tariff calendar, so the same work cost almost half as much again.

The machines didn't change. What matters is how the contract is built around them. How far the power can come down depends on its peaks in each period and on the penalties for excess power. Get it wrong and the savings turn into charges.

What I check: the maxímetro period by period, month by month, against the penalties for going over. Then which contract fits the hours you actually work.

LINE 03

Reactive energy.

Motors, compressors, fridges, pumps and air conditioning draw energy they then give back to the grid. On 3.0TD and 6.1TD bills, above a certain level, you are charged for it.

WHERE TO LOOK A line called "Energía reactiva", in euros.

WARNING SIGN Any amount, appearing every month.

What it looks like in different businesses

Bar or restaurant	Fridges, freezers, cold rooms, extractors and air conditioning: the classic source.
Shop	Refrigerated displays, air conditioning and older lighting.
Hotel or holiday let	Pool pumps and air conditioning, especially in summer.
Factory or workshop	Presses, compressors and motors, in a footwear factory or any production line. It can be one of the biggest lines on the bill.
Cold storage	Compressors running day and night, all year.

REAL BILLS

On the small hotel's bills, between **6 and 14 euros every month**. Around **120 euros a year** for something that buys nothing. In a business with more machines, it is usually more.

The footwear factory paid **13 euros** of reactive energy in August, a month it barely worked.

What I check: whether it is worth dealing with depends on the amount, your equipment and what it would cost. I tell you whether it pays off.

LINE 04

Meter rental.

A regulated daily rent for the meter, when it belongs to the distribution company. Small on a household-size 2.0TD bill. On 3.0TD and 6.1TD, often around a euro a day.

WHERE TO LOOK "Alquiler de equipos de medida", in euros, usually near the end of the bill.

WARNING SIGNS You're not sure who owns the meter. Or a saving study from a supplier shows almost no rental "with us".

Why it matters to every business

The rental itself rarely changes when you switch supplier, because it is regulated. That is exactly why it is useful to anyone who wants to make a saving look bigger than it is. If a comparison puts the rental on "your current bill" and leaves it out of "with us", the saving is partly invented.

What it looks like in different businesses

Bar, shop or office	Around a euro a day adds up to a few hundred euros a year. Enough to make a weak offer look good.
Hotel or holiday let	Often more than one supply, and more than one meter to pay for.
Factory or cold store	Larger meters, higher rent, and one-off regulated charges that some studies count as "savings".

A REAL STUDY

An agent gave the small hotel a comparison with the meter rental at **30.51 euros a month** on "your current bill" and **0.73 euros** "with us". After the switch, the rental stayed exactly the same. About **430 euros a year**, tax included, of the promised saving was rent. The full story is two pages on.

What I check: whether your rental is right depends on who owns the meter and what type it is. And any study you have been given, line by line.

LINE 05

Fixed or indexed, and your contract dates.

With an indexed price, what you pay for each kWh moves with the wholesale market, hour by hour. With a fixed price, it stays the same until the contract ends.

WHERE TO LOOK The name of your tariff: "Precio de mercado", "Indexado" or "Index" means your price follows the market. "Fijo" means it doesn't. Then the contract end date ("Fecha fin de contrato") and the conditions for leaving early.

WARNING SIGNS You don't know which one you have. Your contract renews on its own. Or there is a penalty for leaving that nobody mentioned. On indexed bills, also look for extra lines such as "Reliquidación costes del sistema": the footwear factory paid 12.42 euros in August for costs recalculated on July's consumption.

What it looks like in different businesses

Bar or restaurant	With so much solar in Spain, midday energy is often cheap and evening energy expensive. A business that works at night feels the market more.
Shop or office	Daytime hours, so the indexed price behaves differently than for a bar.
Holiday let or villa	Summer peaks and empty months: the same contract can suit one season and not the other.
Large consumer	On an indexed price, the supplier's margin per MWh is the number to watch. On a big bill, small numbers become large amounts.
Any business	Business contracts often renew on their own, sometimes at new prices nobody announced.

REAL BILLS

The small hotel's owners didn't know they were on a market price. In their cheapest period, the energy price **doubled between April and September**. Same contract, same supplier, and nobody called them.

A food company in Murcia uses about **2.35 GWh a year** on an indexed price. Every euro of supplier margin per MWh is about **2,350 euros a year**.

What I check: whether to fix, when and for how long depends on how and when you use electricity, and on your contract dates. The wrong moment can cost you a year.

REAL CASE · ALL FIVE LINES

The hotel's bill.

A small hotel in Spain, closed from November to March. An agent promised the owners about a thousand euros a year in savings. Their bills went up instead, and nobody could tell them why.

What the five lines showed	
01 · Own transformer, billed as 3.0TD	**being checked**
02 · Meter not read, bills estimated, corrected eight months later	**552 €**
02 · Bills in the closed months	**~300 € a month**
03 · Reactive energy, every month	**6 to 14 €**
04 · Part of the promised saving that was really rent	**~430 € a year**
05 · Energy price in the cheapest period, April → September	**doubled**
From the hotel's own bills and the study the agent gave them. Names removed.	

What it shows

Nobody did anything illegal. The promised saving was built on a meter rental that was never going to change. The costs that did change, the estimated readings, the market price, the power paid in the closed months, had nobody looking at them.

This is the most common story I hear from business owners: the switch was easy, the explanation never came, and the person who sold it stopped answering. I'm going through it with them line by line, and every answer goes to them in writing.

What I check: all five lines together, on your bills and on any study you were given. One line on its own rarely tells the whole story.

REAL CASE · THE ONE AN AGENT WOULDN'T SHOW YOU

The 12% that was really 7%.

A food company in Murcia. Cold rooms running day and night, about 2.35 GWh a year on an indexed price. A supplier's comparison promised a saving of about 12%.

The comparison, read line by line	
Saving shown in the comparison	~12%
One-off regulated charge counted as a "saving"	1,696 €
It isn't energy, and it doesn't disappear by switching	—
Real saving, once it's taken out	~7%

Why this page is here

The saving was real. It just wasn't 12%. On a bill that size, 7% is still a lot of money. But if you decide on 12% and get 7%, you will feel cheated, and you will be right to ask why.

So I don't round up. The number in my report is the one that survives a line-by-line reading, even when it's smaller than the one you were shown. And some of my reviews end with two words: change nothing.

What I check: every comparison you have been given, line by line, against your own bill. Regulated charges, rentals and one-off items stay on both sides.

THE CHECKLIST

10-minute self-audit.

Get your most recent electricity bill in front of you and work through these checks. If any one of them flags, your bill is probably costing you money.

- [ ] **01 · Tarifa de acceso**
  Does it say 2.0TD, 3.0TD or 6.1TD? Is there a transformer on your property?
- [ ] **02 · Potencia contratada and Potencia máxima demandada**
  Is the maxímetro far below or above your contracted power? Is there a line called "Excesos de potencia"?
- [ ] **03 · Lectura estimada**
  Does the bill say the reading was estimated, or does the maxímetro show 0 or "-"?
- [ ] **04 · Energía reactiva**
  Is there any amount, month after month?
- [ ] **05 · Alquiler de equipos de medida**
  Around a euro a day? Do you know who owns the meter? Did a study you were given leave it out?
- [ ] **06 · Tariff name and Fecha fin de contrato**
  "Precio de mercado", "Indexado", "Index" or "Fijo"? When does it end, and what does leaving early cost?

Count your warning signs.

3 or more	Your bill is very likely costing you money.
1 or 2	There is probably money to recover.
None	Good sign. If you want a second pair of eyes, send it anyway and I'll tell you in writing.

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Sergio Vega.

I'm Sergio, based in Alicante. Before electricity bills, I spent years in industry: developing products, supporting customers and helping them improve production lines. I read a bill the way I used to read a production line, line by line, looking for what is being wasted.

Most business owners I talk to have the same story. They changed supplier through an agent, the bill went up, and the agent stopped answering. That is the gap I fill: I read the bill, I explain it in plain English, and I answer when you write. I work in English and Spanish.

Households came first. This year I've started reading business bills too: a small hotel, two factories and a food company, the cases you've seen in this guide. The method is the same. The numbers are bigger.

What I do, and what I don't

I DO	Read every line of your bill and any study you were given. Put the answer in writing, with the numbers. Stay on after you sign: if the first bill with the new supplier is wrong, I'm the one who checks it.
I DON'T	Ring you if you didn't ask. Round a saving up. Move you when staying is the better answer, or when leaving early would cost you a penalty.

Most of the work isn't the switch

Much of what clients thank me for has nothing to do with changing supplier. It's knowing what they pay and why. And it's the paperwork: the calls, the forms and the complaints nobody else wants to deal with.

NOT THE PRICE	One client's bill had shot up and she was sure it was the price. It wasn't. It was the water heater. No new contract would have fixed that.
PAPERWORK	Another went 119 days without a meter reading and got an inflated estimated bill. That became a formal complaint, and I do the paperwork.
IN A BUSINESS	The same two questions, with bigger numbers. Is it the price, or is it the consumption: a cold room, a compressor running at night, air conditioning left on in a closed month? And who deals with the distribution company, the meter, the change of power? I do.

How I get paid

The check is free. If you change supplier through me, the new supplier pays me a commission. I tell you how much, in writing, before you decide. Your data is used only to read your bill, and I don't pass it to any company unless you ask me to.

WHAT CLIENTS SAY

Before your bill, theirs.

Business bills are new for me this year. Household bills aren't. This is what the people whose bills I've read have written back, word for word, names removed.

> **"I just thought I'd send you my first full month and to say thanks, I'm impressed."**
>
> A client, with the first full bill of the new contract attached.

"You have earned the recommendation."
A client who signed 38 hours after joining this list.

"Wow you are very efficient."
A client, after receiving her proposal.

"Both of them now."
A client who moved one supply first, then asked me to read the second.

"We feel we can proceed."
A client who came back after a first "not yet".

33
households have switched with me so far.

10
of them came because a client passed my name on.

1 in 3
reviews, roughly, end with "stay where you are".

What the service looks like

10 H	A reader sent her bill ten minutes after downloading my guide. Her review went back ten hours later.
TOLD TO STAY	A reader would have paid a penalty to leave early, so I told him to wait for his contract to end. Months later he sent me a friend whose power was double what it needed to be. The client who has sent me the most people is one I told to stay.
STOPPED IT	A client spotted a detail in a contract before signing. I stopped the signature myself, checked it, and only then went ahead.
FOUND	A protection pack nobody had asked for, 243 euros a year. I told the owner to cancel it with one call and wait seven months for the contract to end, then move. No penalty.

YOUR NEXT STEP · FREE CHECK, NO COMMITMENT

When you're ready, send me one bill.

1 **Take a photo of your latest bill.**
All pages. Cover your name and address if you prefer. If an agent gave you a study, send that too.

2 **Send it by WhatsApp or email.**
No forms, no calls you didn't ask for.

3 **Within two working days, a written report.**
What's right, what's wrong, what each line is costing you, and whether to change anything. If the answer is "change nothing", that's what it will say.

Every month on the wrong power or the wrong price is paid in full, and business contracts often renew on their own. **The best moment to check is before your renewal date, not after it.**

WHATSAPP
+34 672 90 75 94
A photo of your bill. That's it.

EMAIL
sergio@sergiovega.es
Attach the bill or a photo.

Meanwhile, over the next two weeks

Five short emails, one line each, with what I see in bars, shops, holiday lets, hotels and factories. Then two more on how I work, and after that a short note most mornings about a real bill. One click unsubscribes you. No spam. No pressure.

1 · The access tariff, and the transformer nobody mentions.
2 · Power: paid every day, open or closed.
3 · Reactive energy: paying for energy that buys nothing.
4 · Meter rental, and how saving studies get it wrong.
5 · Fixed or indexed, and the dates in your contract.

Sergio
Todo irá bien.

The examples in this guide come from real business bills reviewed in 2026, with names removed. Every business is different, and your numbers will be too. The review is free and there is no obligation to change supplier.